freed by his master's wife, married, and then served with local troops. He raised his own cavalry which grew from 150 to 7000 in a short span of time and revitalized the Ahmadnagar kingdom by appointing puppet Sultans to thwart Mughal attacks from the north. By 1610, his army had 10,000 Habshis and 40,000 Deccanis. Over the next decade, he frustrated Mughal Emperor Jahangir, not only by the size of his army but also by the colour of his skin as race was an important marker that shaped Jahangir's perception of Malik Ambar. But when Ambar finally died in 1626, even Mughal chroniclers submitted that he had lived an honourable life and praised his guerrilla warfare that possibly inspired the Shivaji-led Maratha ascendance in the late 17th century. The Ethiopian military labour market by then had disappeared as the Ahmadnagar kingdom had fallen to the Mughals in 1636. The remaining Habshis, mostly men, were absorbed into local society.

The Siddi community of India, closely related to the Habshis, runs into tens of thousands of people today and is found in the states of Karnataka, Maharashtra and Gujarat. Among the masterpieces of Siddi craftsmanship in the 16th century is the beautiful and intricate window screen of the Sidi Saiyyed mosque in Ahmedabad, which inspired the logo of the Indian Institute of Management in the city (IIM-A). I often point this out to the students there, as an example of what the institute strives to achieve: creativity and the upward mobility of a diverse student body. Students, in turn, have pointed out an important difference: that they willingly submit themselves to a life of corporate slavery!

Modern Migrations: From Horse Power to Horsepower

This brief outline of Indian migration history over several millennia has thrown up a galaxy of actors. In alphabetical order, they are: accountants, animals, artisans, ascetics, ayahs, banjaras, colonizers, cooks, couriers, courtesans, entertainers, lascars, mercenaries, merchants, missionaries, monks, nomads, nuns, *pattamar*s, pastoralists, pilgrims, priests, prostitutes, slaves, spies, students, thieves, travellers, warriors, weavers, wives, and that